# TAME JOY

Lawrence Kirk / Lumen the SIM

Thundershark Gallery | Washington, DC



*TAME JOY* is an exhibition of fragmented memory and haunted nostalgia. It follows a pathway carved by impulse, imagination, and play as these things turn into value, commodity, and a fetishization of the past.

At its core, the show is a reanimation of something that was once living. A kind of necromancy brought on by the age of gacha games, collectible obsession, and the AI slopification of nostalgic images. Characters, memories, and familiar forms return as things to collect, possess, and encounter again.

The series exists as an archive and a container for my own memories, social memetic phenomena, and previous shows and works I have performed over the years. It includes returning characters from *World_Type* and *The Ballad of Bunko*, brought together here in new physical and digital forms.

The sculptures, or “trophies” as I call them, are synthesized using Blender and Meshy, printed in PLA, and painted by hand. My work is intended to evoke awe through scale and emotion through the intimacy of hand-painted digital forms.

Each character is also represented digitally through a “pseudo-sloptimized” animation. These animations involve roughly ten different modes of process, moving between physical space and digital capture.

*TAME JOY* brings these processes and histories together through the pleasure of making, the obsession of collecting, and the strange feeling of bringing something back.

Welcome to *TAME JOY*. I hope you enjoy the show!

# Exhibition details & credits

**Exhibition:** TAME JOY

**Artist:** Lawrence Kirk / Lumen the SIM

**Photography:** Lawrence Kirk / Lumen the SIM

**Venue:** Thundershark Gallery
52 O St NW, Suite 202C
Washington, DC 20001
Inside 52 O Street Studios

**Opening:** October 2, 2026
**Closing event and party:** October 31, 2026

**Social media:** @lumen_floss

**Website:** lum3nation.net

**Installation checklist**

All works are part of the exhibition installation under the umbrella of *TAME JOY*, by Lawrence Kirk / Lumen the SIM. The installation includes hand-painted PLA trophies and accompanying digital animations.

Individual character names can be found in the Shopify marketplace established for trading trophies online:

lumenation-mall-of.myshopify.com